



Realme will be 440% faster

Realme MagDart will be 440% faster than Apple Magsafe, teases CEO.
<https://digit.in/aug21-19>



Huawei P50 series launched

Huawei P50 series launched with 50MP cameras and more. Specifications and features. <https://digit.in/aug21-20>

Wireless domination

Wireless headphones are gradually stealing the limelight

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It has been a strange year of testing at the Digit test lab when it comes to the headphones

category. Since January 1, 2021, we've had no wired headphones come to us for review, it has just been a sea of wireless and truly wireless earbuds that have shown up at our test lab. In fact, the last wired headphone we tested (apart from gaming headsets) was the Beyerdynamic T1 3rd Gen – a pair of audiophile-grade cans that are exorbitantly priced. This is a real indication of where the headphone market, especially in India, is headed towards. The days of wired headphones hogging all the limelight seem to be behind us, with wireless headphones now being the centre of attention for audio manufacturers and a great chunk of consumers alike.

Make no mistake, we're in no way saying that wired headphones are barely being used. There are audiophiles and purists that still swear by wired, and for good reason. Wired headphones receive an analogue signal, which means they can handle more data than Bluetooth, resulting in better sound quality. Most high-end headphones that audiophiles swear by are wired, often chained to amps. So, wired headphones are still

prevalent, however, it's the purchasing patterns now that have seen an overhaul. A few years ago, wired headphones still sold more than their wireless counterparts. However, in 2016, wireless headphones actually managed to outsell wired headphones in the US for the first time ever, according to consumer research firm NPD group.



It's no surprise why this change took place in 2016 since that is the year Apple announced the Apple AirPods that revolutionised the headphone industry. The breakout success of the AirPods caused other companies to get up and take notice, and follow suit. Soon, there were true wireless earphones being released by numerous audio companies such as Sennheiser, Sony, Bose,

Jabra, and others, with everyone vying for a piece of the action. The headphone category, as a whole, saw a 7 per cent YoY increase in sales in 2016 and Bluetooth headphones, on the other hand, witnessed a whopping 42 per cent YoY increase in sales in 2016. A year later in 2017, the revenue for sales of wireless headphones corresponded to \$850

million compared to the \$120 million revenue of the wired headphone category.

Consumer audio, in particular, has seen this market change, with the majority of the new launches in 2021 and even 2020 being wireless. Additionally, the companies also tend to promote

their wireless launches much more than their wired counterparts leading to the trend of more people going the wireless route. Of course, the rapid removal of 3.5mm audio jacks from smartphones has also led to this trend, with only a few new phones sporting the 3.5mm jack in 2021. Experts predict the sales of wireless headphones to keep going upwards in the coming years. The